Decent Coaching Classes

X Nisha

Academic Conquest - VIII

ANSWER KEY

Subject: English – 1.1 A Teenager's Prayer, 1.2 An Encounter of a Special Kind

Time: 1 Hour **Marks: 30**

Q.1 **8**

(A1) (a) the sudden attack from unknown quarters forced it. (b) they saw the prospect of a good kill and meal. [1 mark each]

(A2) (a) The narrator used a stick to keep the dogs at bay. (b) He caught hold of the baby langur's tail just as it tipped over the edge of the tiled roof. [1 mark each]

(A3) The narrator was brave, kind and quick to act. He risked himself to rescue a helpless baby without thinking of his own safety, which shows his compassion for animals. (Any suitable opinion with a reason: 2 marks)

(A4) (a) listless (b) assault [1 mark each]

Q.2 **6**

(A1) (a) temptation (b) clean [1 mark each]

(A2) (a) abcb (make/take rhyme in lines 2 and 4) (b) Apostrophe (the poet speaks directly to the Lord) [1 mark each]

(A3) The poet prays to the Lord to open his eyes so he can see clearly and choose the right road of success, to help him stand for what is right and say 'no' to temptation, to keep his body clean and fit, and to walk beside him so that his teenage years are lived at their best. (2 marks)

Q.3 **4**

(a) – (iv) (b) – (iii) (c) – (ii) (d) – (i) [1 mark each; (v) is extra]

Q.4 **4**

(A) (1) The baby langur was saved by the narrator. (2) He said that he would help the injured bird. [1 mark each]

(B) (1) Simile (comparison using 'like'). (2) Apostrophe (addressing the books directly). [1 mark each]

Q.5 Model answers (any one) **8**

Marking: title 1, content/points 4, language and grammar 2, spelling/punctuation 1.

(A) Our Best Friends

Birds and animals are our best friends. They are loyal and serve us in many ways. Dogs guard our homes, cows give us milk and horses carry loads. Their love and affection for us is unconditional. When we show them kindness and compassion, they give us protection and security in return. A pet dog waits for its master all day and welcomes him with joy. We should never hurt or destroy these innocent creatures. Instead, we must feed them, protect them and treat them with care. A world with birds and animals is richer and happier, so we should respect them as true friends.

(B) Appreciation of 'A Teenager's Prayer'

The poem 'A Teenager's Prayer' is written by J. Morse. It has five stanzas and its rhyme scheme is abcb. The central idea is that a teenager prays for guidance to choose the right path in life. The poet says that

each day brings new decisions and the choice of the road – of success or of distress – is ours alone. He asks the Lord to open his eyes, to help him stand for what is right and to say ‘no’ to temptation. The poem uses apostrophe, as the poet speaks directly to God, and alliteration, as in ‘life is lived’. My favourite line is ‘Help me stand for what is right, bring out the best in me’. The language is simple and the tone is sincere and prayerful. I like the poem because it gives teenagers a positive message to make wise decisions and live life at its best.